Environmental variation

9A Genetics and evolution · Lesson 1 of 7

Date _____ Class _____

Today I can 今天我能

- ☐ I can describe abiotic and biotic environmental factors and give examples of environmental variation.
- ☐ I can tell continuous variation from discontinuous variation, and explain why environmental variation can make classification difficult.

What happens today

1. Do Now: the dragon of Krakow
2. Learn: Environmental factors · Environmental variation · and more
3. Core tasks
4. Challenge, then the exit ticket

Student Book pages 5 to 7 · Workbook pages 3 to 4

What I learned today (one or two sentences) 今天我学到了：

Key Vocabulary

Term	中文	Definition
species	物种	a group of organisms that can breed together to produce offspring that can also breed
extinct	灭绝的	a species with no living members left
environment	环境	the surroundings of an organism
abiotic factor	非生物因素	a physical (non-living) part of the environment, e.g. temperature
biotic factor	生物因素	the activities of other organisms, e.g. predation, disease
characteristic	特征	a feature of an organism
variation	变异	the differences between the characteristics of organisms
environmental variation	环境变异	variation caused by an organism's environment
continuous variation	连续变异	variation that can have any value between two points
discontinuous variation	不连续变异	variation with only a limited set of possible values
classification	分类	sorting organisms into groups

Command words 指令词: Complete 完成（填写） · Draw 画出 · Give 给出 · Give a reason 给出理由 · Label 标注 · Match 连线（配对） · Plot 绘制（数据点） · Suggest 提出（建议） · Tick 打勾 · Use 使用（运用）

Quick Review

the dragon of Krakow

A story says these bones are from a fire-breathing dragon killed by Krak, a shoemaker's apprentice.

1 What animals could the bones really be from?

2 What does 'extinct' mean?

3 Name one species that is extinct.

Core 1 of 4

Everyone does these. Answer on the card or under it. 人人都做，答案写在卡片上或下面。

1 Match each key word to its meaning. Draw a line.

species	the surroundings of an organism
extinct	a non-living factor, e.g. temperature or light
environment	a species with no living members left
abiotic factor	a group of organisms that can breed together to produce offspring that can also breed
biotic factor	the activities of other organisms, e.g. predation or disease

Core 2 of 4

Everyone does these. Answer on the card or under it. 人人都做，答案写在卡片上或下面。

2 Tick one box in each row to show whether the factor is abiotic or biotic.

Environmental factor	Abiotic	Biotic
temperature		
predation (being hunted)		
amount of light		
competition for food		
rainfall		
infectious disease		

Core 3 of 4

Everyone does these. Answer on the card or under it. 人人都做，答案写在卡片上或下面。

3 Twenty potatoes of the same variety were weighed. Their masses in grams were: 142, 118, 165, 151, 137, 174, 129, 158, 146, 183, 121, 160, 149, 133, 171, 155, 140, 127, 163, 148.

a) Complete the tally chart.

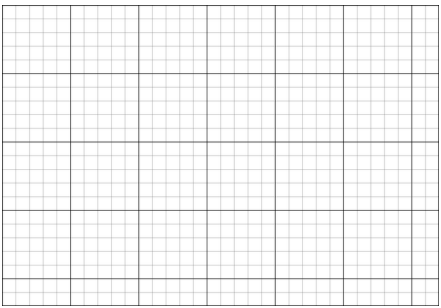
Mass range (g)	Tally	Number of potatoes
110 to 129		
130 to 149		
150 to 169		
170 to 189		

Core 4 of 4

Everyone does these. Answer on the card or under it. 人人都做，答案写在卡片上或下面。

3 *continued*

b) Plot a bar chart of the number of potatoes in each mass range on the grid below. Label both axes.



c) Is potato mass continuous or discontinuous variation? Give a reason.

Challenge 1 of 2

When Core is finished. Full sentences. 完成基础题后做；请写完整句子。

C1 A plant on a seashore has pink flowers and is 10 cm tall. On a nearby island, similar plants are over 50 cm tall with dark purple flowers. Scientists grew seeds from both places in the same laboratory. All the plants grew to look the same.

a) What does this tell you about the plants from the two areas?

b) Use this example to explain how environmental variation can make it difficult to identify plant species.

Challenge 2 of 2

When Core is finished. Full sentences. 完成基础题后做；请写完整句子。

C2 In 2003, bones of adult humans just over 1 m tall were found on Flores Island. Some scientists think they were our species but had too little iodine in their diet; others think they were a different species that is now extinct. Suggest what evidence would help scientists decide, and explain your reasoning.

Exit Ticket

Hand this card in at the end of the lesson.

Name _____

1 Give one abiotic factor and one biotic factor in a pond.

2 Is a scar an example of inherited or environmental variation?

3 Is foot length continuous or discontinuous variation? Give a reason.

Today I can: Goal 1 ☐ Goal 2 ☐